



How does passing the 1.5°C threshold create new diplomatic and climate challenges for India?

GS Paper III
Environment
Pollution and Degradation

📖 KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Irreversible Overshoot Damage:** Breaching 1.5°C triggers permanent environmental loss that basic adaptation cannot repair. Cooling the planet after crossing safe limits is far harder than stopping emissions now, forcing every country to rethink its core long-term climate survival plans.
- **Growing Methane Scrutiny:** International bodies increasingly pressure nations to slash methane emissions quickly. India has avoided global methane treaties because farming and livestock sustain millions of rural livelihoods, creating intense friction with wealthy countries that focus narrowly on immediate gas cuts.
- **Shifting Diplomatic Perceptions:** Vulnerable neighbors now group India with historical heavy polluters due to its massive total emissions. This complicates India's traditional stance as a climate victim, demanding smarter diplomatic communication to balance rapid domestic development with regional ecological duties.
- **Climate Finance Inequity:** Rich countries historically released most atmospheric carbon but fail to provide promised funding and green technology. Developing nations argue that without adequate adaptation money, demanding rapid emission cuts unfairly threatens economic growth and poverty eradication.
- **Short-Lived Climate Pollutants:** Methane traps far more heat than carbon dioxide over shorter periods, causing one-third of current warming. Slashing short-lived climate pollutants provides immediate cooling benefits, making it an attractive fast-track target for global mitigation treaties.

📄 QUICK FACTS

- UNEP's Limiting Overshoot report warns that existing global policies lead to 2.6°C of heating, while fully meeting all national climate pledges still results in 1.8°C of warming.
- Methane contributes approximately 0.5°C of current global warming, prompting scientists to target it as the fastest and most effective way to slow near-term heating compared to carbon dioxide.
- More than 155 countries joined the Global Methane Pledge targeting a 30% cut in anthropogenic methane below 2020 levels by 2030, though India has remained outside this agreement.
- Following the catastrophic Bhotekoshi flood disaster, Nepal officially urged major industrial emitters including China, the United States, and India to recognize climate damage inflicted on vulnerable Himalayan nations.

🎯 KEY TAKEAWAY

As temporary temperature overshoot becomes reality, India must defend its developmental space while proactively addressing short-lived pollutants and reassuring vulnerable neighbors through balanced, transparent, and collaborative climate diplomacy.



Why must public healthcare expand beyond reproductive years to support women facing menopause?

GS Paper II
Governance
Issues Relating to Health

📖 KNOWLEDGE POINTS

- **Ending Silent Suffering:** Most public healthcare programs only focus on pregnancy and childbirth. Consequently, millions of older women are forced to silently endure severe physical fatigue, emotional distress, and joint pain during menopause without any basic medical support.
- **Routine Healthcare Integration:** Bringing menopause care into routine government health centers ensures early diagnosis. Through regular screening, counseling, and referrals at primary health centers, women can access timely treatment for severe symptoms instead of being dismissed or ignored.
- **Sensitizing Medical Staff:** Doctors and families often dismiss menopausal symptoms as normal aging rather than real medical issues. Public health policies help train medical professionals to validate women's complaints, eliminate clinical bias, and provide proper treatment with dignity.
- **Understanding Biological Changes:** Menopause marks the permanent end of menstrual cycles due to falling estrogen and progesterone levels. The transitional perimenopause phase brings hot flashes, mood swings, and sleep disruption that significantly harm daily living.
- **Promoting Gender Equity:** Neglecting non-reproductive health reduces older women's workforce participation and quality of life. Expanding public care recognizes health as a lifelong fundamental right, fulfilling constitutional promises of equality and social justice for aging women.

📄 QUICK FACTS

- Menopause is clinically established after twelve consecutive months without menstrual cycles, triggered by ovaries reducing the natural synthesis of essential hormones namely oestrogen and progesterone.
- Karnataka launched Ruthu Thare on August 4, establishing the country's first dedicated public health framework addressing mid-life medical challenges like perimenopause and menopause.
- Tamil Nadu announced its comprehensive perimenopausal health policy on August 17 to facilitate early symptom detection, professional counselling, and institutional treatment through primary health centres.
- Both southern state policies institute structured tiered care, connecting grassroots community screening and dedicated well-women clinics to specialized treatments at district hospitals and government medical colleges.

🎯 KEY TAKEAWAY

Integrating perimenopause care into routine public healthcare transforms mid-life women's well-being by providing community-level diagnosis, clinical validation, and targeted medical therapy for disruptive physical and psychological transitions.